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HSBC India has set up 'Innovation Banking', a platform designed to support start-ups at every stage



INDIA'S GLOBAL BANK

A conservative balance sheet, disciplined growth, and sharp execution have helped HSBC India stand out among foreign banks and bag two awards

BY ANAND ADHIKARI

FOREIGN BANKS IN India have long been associated with cyclical expansion and retreat, selling businesses, or downsizing operations. But HSBC India—with a presence in the country spanning over 170 years—has stayed focused, and is quietly racing ahead. “Our ambition is clear: we want to be the fifth-largest private bank in India, while remaining true to our principles,” says Hitendra Dave, CEO of HSBC India. HSBC India is ranked 8th among private banks based on total assets.

Dave says HSBC is long-term in its thinking and relationship-oriented in its approach. “There are many clients whose values and ways of thinking align with ours,” he says.

Today, almost half of MNCs bank with HSBC India. It has the highest market share in GCCs. The bank has been supporting a

record number of acquisitions by Indian companies abroad. It is a full-service foreign bank, offering salary accounts, mortgages, credit cards, wealth management, and NRI services, apart from several other international products.

The strategy is beginning to show in the numbers. HSBC India has posted one of the strongest growth among foreign banks operating in the country.

According to the BT-KPMG India's Best Banks & NBFCs Survey, loans and advances grew 26% year-on-year, the second in the peer set, while the three-year CAGR is a robust 19.2%, suggesting this is not a one-off spike.

Dave gives three reasons for the bank's high growth. “We have always maintained a very conservative balance sheet. And that is for a reason—when our customers say, ‘today we need financing,’ that is when we step up,” he says. Dave says the bank is not in the